قصص بالعامية الفلسطينية · BOOK 1

كعك القدس

ka3ek il-2uds

The Jerusalem Ka'ak



اللهجة الفلسطينية — القدس

Spoken Palestinian (Jerusalem). No fus7a, no tashkeel.

How to read this book

Every page gives you the Arabic first. Underneath, in smaller type, you get the Jerusalem pronunciation in chat-alphabet, then the English. Try to read the Arabic aloud before you look down.

THE CHAT ALPHABET USED HERE

7	ح	hard breathy H — *7abeebi, sob7*
5	خ	kh, like Swedish/German *ach* — *5aalid, 5ams*
3	ع	ayn, deep in the throat — *3ammo, ka3ek*
2	ء ق	glottal stop. In Jerusalem city speech **ق is a glottal stop**: قال = *2aal*, سوق = *sou2*
gh	غ	like a French r — *ghmeeda, zgheer*
aa ee oo	ا ي و	long vowels — hold them; *baab* is not *bab*

About that ق. You may also see **8** used for ق in texting. That spelling belongs to people who actually pronounce it — village Palestinians, Jordanians (often as a hard *g*), Bedouin. In Jerusalem, Jaffa, Nablus town centre, Damascus and Beirut, ق is simply a glottal stop, so this book writes it as **2**. Both are correct Levantine — just pick one and be consistent.

THREE HABITS THAT KEEP YOU OUT OF FUS7A

SAY	NOT		
بدي	~~أريد~~	*biddi*	I want
شو	~~ماذا~~	*shou*	what
بروح	~~أذهب~~	*barou7*	I go

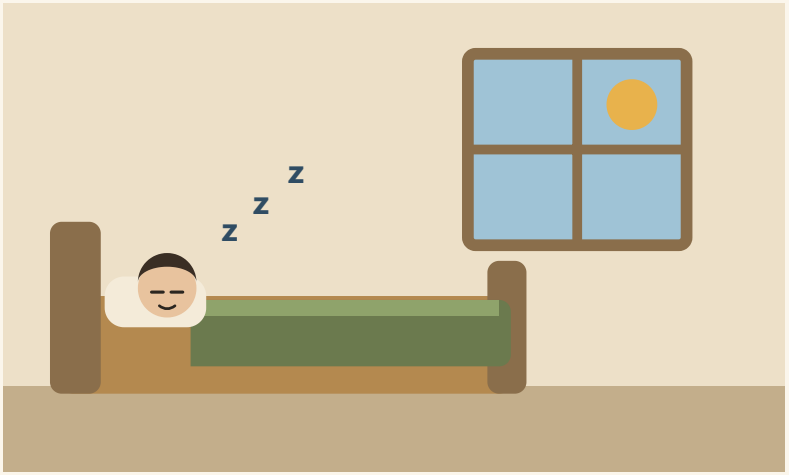


هاد سامي.
سامي ولد عمره سبع سنين.
هو ساكن في القدس، جنب باب العامود.

---

haad Saami.
Saami walad 3omro sabe3 sneen.
huwwe saakin fil-2uds, janb baab il-3amoud.

This is Sami. Sami is a boy, seven years old. He lives in Jerusalem, right by Damascus Gate.



كل يوم الصبح، إمه بتقله:

«يلا يا سامي، قوم! رح تتأخر عالمدرسة!»

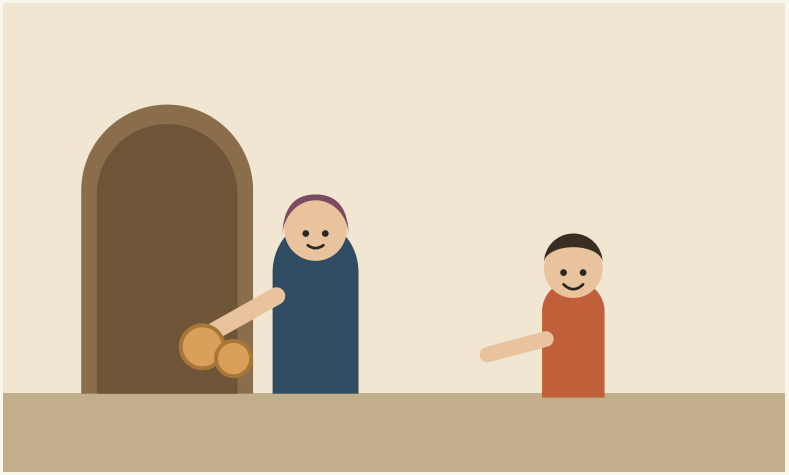
سامي بيفتح عيونه شوي شوي وبيقول:

«خمس دقايق كمان يا ماما!»

---

kill yom is-sob7, immo bit2ello:
“yalla ya Saami, 2oum! ra7 tit2a55ar 3al-madrase!”
Saami byifta7 3youno shway shway w-bi2oul:
“5ams da2aaye2 kamaan ya maama!”

Every morning his mum says to him: “Come on Sami, get up! You're going to be late for school!” Sami opens his eyes little by little and says: “Five more minutes, Mum!”



بس اليوم الجمعة. ما في مدرسة!
إمه عطته عشر شيكل وقالتله:
«روح جبلنا كعك من عند أبو خالد.»

bass il-yom ij-jum3a. maa fee madrase!
immo 3atito 3ashar shekel w-2aalatlo:
“rou7 jiblna ka3ek min 3ind Abu 5aalid.”

But today is Friday. No school! His mum gave him ten shekels and said to him: “Go bring us some ka'ak from Abu Khalid's.”



سامي نزل عالسوق. الدنيا زحمة كتير.

في ناس عم بتشتري خضرة، وفي ناس عم بتحكي وبتضحك.

وريحة الكعك بالسمسم ملت الشارع كله.

Saami nizil 3as-sou2. id-dinya za7me kteer.
fee naas 3am btishtiri 5adra, w-fee naas 3am bti7ki w-btid7ak.
w-ree7it il-ka3ek bis-simsim malat ish-shaari3 killo.

Sami went down to the market. It was really packed. Some people were buying vegetables, some were talking and laughing. And the smell of sesame ka'ak filled the whole street.



«صباح الخير يا عمو!»

«صباح النور يا سامي! شو بدك اليوم؟»

«بدي أربع كعكات، ومعهم زعتر لو سمحت.»

“saba7 il-5eer ya 3ammo!”

“saba7 in-nour ya Saami! shou biddak il-yom?”

“biddi arba3 ka3kaat, w-ma3hom za3tar law sama7t.”

“Good morning, uncle!” “Good morning, Sami! What do you want today?” “I'd like four ka'ak, and some za'tar with them, please.”



أبو خالد ضحك وقال:

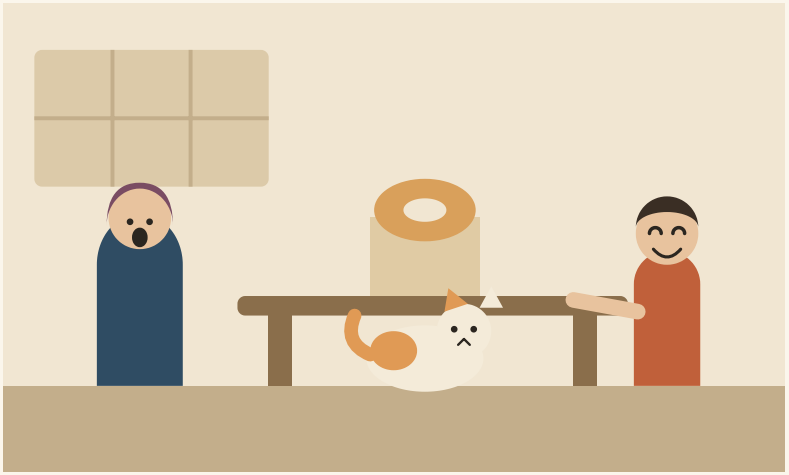
«خدهم، وهاي وحدة كمان هدية إلك.»

سامي فرح كتير وقال:

«يسلمو إيديك يا عمو!»

Abu 5aalid di7ik w-2aal:
“5idhom, w-hayy wa7de kamaan hdiyye 2ilak.”
Saami firi7 kteer w-2aal:
“yislamo 2ideek ya 3ammo!”

Abu Khalid laughed and said: “Take them, and here's one more as a present for you.” Sami was really happy and said: “Bless your hands, uncle!”



رجع سامي عالبيت وهو ماكل نص كعكة عالطريق.
إمه شافته وقالت:
«يا حرام! مين أكل الكعكة؟»
سامي ضحك وقال:
«مش أنا... القطة!»

---

rija3 Saami 3al-beet w-huwwe maakel nuss ka3ke 3at-taree2.
immo shaafto w-2aalat: "ya 7araam! meen akal il-ka3ke?"
Saami di7ik w-2aal: "mish ana... il-2atta!"

Sami got home having already eaten half a ka'ak on the way. His mum saw him and said: "Oh no! Who ate the ka'ak?" Sami laughed and said: "Not me... the cat!"

Words from this story

All of these are what people actually say in Jerusalem. Where the fus7a word differs, it is noted.

هاد / هاي / هدول	*haad / hayy / hadool*	this (m.) / this (f.) / these
ولد	*walad*	boy · pl. ولاد wlaad
عمره سبع سنين	*3omro sabe3 sneen*	he is seven years old
ساكن	*saakin*	living, residing
جنب	*janb*	next to, beside
الصبح	*is-sob7*	the morning · بالصبح in the morning
إمه	*immo*	his mother · إمي immi my mother
بتقله	*bit2ello*	she says to him (قال + له run together)
يلا	*yalla*	come on, let's go
قوم	*2oum*	get up! · f. قومي 2oumi
رح	*ra7*	will (future) · رح أروح I'll go
تتأخر	*tit2a55ar*	you'll be late
شوي شوي	*shway shway*	slowly, bit by bit
كمان	*kamaan*	also, more, as well
دقايق	*da2aaye2*	minutes · sg. دقيقة da2ee2a
ما في	*maa fee*	there isn't · في fee there is
عطته	*3atito*	she gave him · عطى 3ata to give
جبلنا	*jiblna*	bring us! · جاب jaab to bring
من عند	*min 3ind*	from (someone's place)
نزل	*nizil*	he went down · طلع tili3 he went up

Words from this story · continued

الدنيا زحمة	*id-dinya za7me*	it's crowded (lit. the world is crowded)
كتير	*kteer*	a lot, very
عم بتشتري	*3am btishtiri*	she is buying (right now)
خضرة	*5adra*	vegetables, greens
بتحكي	*bti7ki*	she talks · حكى 7aka to speak (not تكلم)
ريحة	*ree7a*	smell
ملت	*malat*	it filled
شو بدك؟	*shou biddak?*	what do you want? · f. بدك biddek
لو سمحت	*law sama7t*	please (asking a favour)
خدهم	*5idhom*	take them · خد 5od take
هدية إلك	*hdiyye 2ilak*	a present for you
فرح	*firi7*	he was happy, he was glad
يسلمو إيديك	*yislamo 2ideek*	"bless your hands" — thanks for food or a favour
نص	*nuss*	half
شافته	*shaafto*	she saw him · شاف shaaf to see (not رأى)
يا حرام	*ya 7araam*	oh no! / poor thing!
مين	*meen*	who
مش أنا	*mish ana*	not me · مش = the all-purpose "not"

Dialect notes

The grammar behind the story. These five patterns cover most of what makes Palestinian sound Palestinian.

1 · THE بـ PREFIX = ORDINARY PRESENT

Stick بـ on the front of the present tense for anything habitual or general. بروح *barou7* I go · بتروح *btrou7* you go / she goes · بيروح *birou7* he goes · منروح *mnrou7* we go · بتروحوا *btrou7u* you (pl.) go · بيروحوا *birou7u* they go.

2 · عم = RIGHT THIS SECOND

عم بيروح *3am birou7* — he's going, right now. Compare بيروح *birou7* — he goes, generally. From the story: عم بتحكي, عم بتشتري.

3 · رح = FUTURE

رح تتأخر *ra7 tit2a55ar* — you'll be late. You will also hear ح glued on (*7atit2a55ar*) and رايح. Never سوف, never سـ.

4 · TWO DIFFERENT "NOT"

ما goes in front of verbs: ما بعرف *maa ba3ref* I don't know · ما شفته *maa shufto* I didn't see him.

مش goes in front of everything else: مش أنا *mish ana* · مش هون *mish hoon* not here · مش حلو *mish 7ilu* not nice.

Syrians use مو where Palestinians use مش — worth recognising, but stick with مش.

5 · SQUASHING على AND الـ TOGETHER

على + الـ becomes عالـ : عالمدرسة *3al-madrase*, عالسوق *3as-sou2*, عالبيت *3al-beet*. Same trick with بـ : بالسمسم *bis-simsim*. Note how the *l* assimilates to s, t, n, r, d, z, sh — that is the sun-letter rule, and it is alive and well in speech.

Say it this way, not that way

The word on the left is what you will hear in Jerusalem. The struck-through word is the fus7a equivalent — you will read it in books and hear it on the news, but saying it in conversation is exactly what marks someone out as a learner.

PALESTINIAN	FUS7A		
شو	~~ماذا~~	*shou*	what
وين	~~أين~~	*ween*	where
ليش	~~لماذا~~	*leesh*	why
هلأ	~~الآن~~	*halla2*	now (also هسا hassa)
كتير	~~جداً~~	*kteer*	very
إشي	~~شيء~~	*ishi*	thing (very Palestinian)
زلمة	~~رجل~~	*zalame*	man, guy
إجا	~~جاء~~	*ija*	he came
قعد	~~جلس~~	*2a3ad*	he sat
بدو يروح	~~يريد أن يذهب~~	*biddo yrou7*	he wants to go
هون / هناك	~~هنا~~	*hoon / hnaak*	here / there
قديش	~~كم~~	*2addeesh*	how much

Read it out loud. Go back to page 2 and read the story again without looking at the transliteration. The point is not to understand it — you already do — it is to get your mouth used to بدي, شو, عم and the glottal ق until they come out without thinking.